

ANNUAL LEASE FILE AUDIT CHECKLIST

A once-a-year review of documents, money, deadlines, and land conditions

Audit year

Reviewer

Review date

- 1 Complete documents**
Signed agreement, amendments, exhibits, maps, legal descriptions, memoranda, assignments, consents, and releases are together.
- 2 Current parties**
Tenant, developer, operator, lender, servicer, owner, trustee, manager, and notice addresses are current.
- 3 Critical dates**
Options, renewals, rent changes, notices, cure periods, expirations, and security updates are calendared.
- 4 Payment check**
Expected rent, escalators, acreage, indexes, reimbursements, taxes, and revenue shares match amounts received.
- 5 Insurance and security**
Certificates, endorsements, bonds, letters of credit, guaranties, and replacement dates are current.
- 6 Land condition**
Roads, gates, drainage, weeds, erosion, fences, utilities, access, crops, and restoration issues are documented.
- 7 Overlap review**
New leases, easements, mortgages, mineral activity, sales, or family transfers do not create unresolved conflicts.
- 8 Tax and ownership**
Tax bills, rollback exposure, reporting, entity records, estate documents, and payment instructions are current.
- 9 Default and disputes**
Late payments, unapproved uses, damage, complaints, notices, promises, and cure steps are preserved in writing.
- 10 Exit planning**
Decommissioning cost, security, removal duties, restoration standard, releases, and surviving obligations remain adequate.

PRIORITY CORRECTIONS BEFORE THE NEXT ANNUAL REVIEW